

**LISTENING
#33****Teacher's Guide****SCRIPT: APARTMENT LIVING**

Apartment Owner: Hello.

Caller: Hi. I'm calling about the ad for the apartment found in today's newspaper.

Apartment Owner: Okay.

Caller: I'm kind of desperate, and I need something right away.

Apartment Owner: Okay. What would you like to know?

Caller: First of all, how big is it?

Apartment Owner: It's a two-bedroom apartment with a living room, dining room and kitchen, and one bathroom. There's also a place for a washer and dryer.

Caller: Okay, and how old is the apartment complex?

Apartment Owner: Well, let's just say it has a lot of history. To be honest, my great grandfather built it during the 1920s, but it's a very sturdy and sound structure.

Caller: Oh, and . . . so, is the apartment furnished at all?

Apartment Owner: Oh, yeah. The apartment is partially furnished with a refrigerator, stove, and my grandmother's old dishwasher.

Caller: Your grandmother's old dishwasher? Okay. What's the rent?

Apartment Owner: It's \$950 a month.

Caller: Whoa. That is a little steep for me.

Apartment Owner: But you could always split the cost with a roommate.

Caller: Perhaps. Does that include utilities?

Apartment Owner: Well, the rent includes gas and electricity, but not the phone bill. And the water pump is right out the back door.

Caller: Water pump! [Yeah.] Oh, yeah. Well, can I rent month-to-month, or do I have to sign a lease for a longer period of time?

Apartment Owner: We require a 6-month commitment for the apartment, and if you cancel the agreement anytime during that period, hey . . . you lose your deposit.

Caller: Oh, and how much is the deposit?

Apartment Owner: It's \$400, and, of course, this money is used to repair damage or general wear and tear on our apartment, like the leaks in the old roof from last year's snowstorm. Man, that was ugly. Plaster falling down from the ceiling. And I didn't even know there was a rat's nest up there, but we got that taken care of.

Caller: A what? Do I get my deposit back after I move out? That's assuming I even move in.

Apartment Owner: Generally speaking, we return the deposit, minus a small fee for, you know, cleaning the apartment for the next tenant, but if you trash the place, then don't expect to get anything back.

Caller: Okay. Oh, um . . . how close is the apartment to the university campus?

Apartment Owner: It's about eight blocks from campus, but you can catch a number of buses right out in front.

Caller: Oh, so, then, if there's a busy road out front, is it noisy?

Apartment Owner: Well, there are always trade-offs: it's a little noisy with the road outside and the airport behind you, but the place is really convenient because there's a supermarket and shopping center right across the street. Just keep the windows closed and a pair of earplugs handy, and you'll be fine.

Caller: Okay, and one last question. Are there parking spaces for tenants?

Apartment Owner: Yeah. The apartment has two covered parking spaces, which are really convenient during certain times of the year.

Caller: Uh . . . I don't know. Is it possible for me to drop by and visit the apartment tomorrow morning?

Apartment Owner: Sure, but just remember we rent the apartment on a first-come, first-served basis, so there's no guarantee it'll still be available then.

Caller: Okay. Thanks. Um . . . and where exactly is the apartment located?

Apartment Owner: It's one block west of the wastewater treatment plant.

Caller: Ah . . . Are pets allowed?

Apartment Owner: Well, you can keep small pets like a hamster in a small cage, but we don't allow larger animals like dogs, cats, or snakes. Things like that.

Caller: Um, I have a rat . . .

Apartment Owner: You don't, you don't have anything like that, do you?

Caller: Well, I have a rat that I keep in a cage. Will that be okay?

Apartment Owner: Well, as long it doesn't escape, I guess that's okay.

Caller: And what's your name?

Apartment Owner: It's Norman. Norman Bates.

Audio Comprehension Questions:

1. b) She needs a place to live right away
2. b) Two
3. a) A refrigerator, stove, and dishwasher
4. c) \$950
5. b) Gas and electricity
6. b) They lose their deposit
7. c) Because of a busy road and an airport nearby
8. It is about eight blocks from the university campus.
9. c) A rat

Reading Comprehension Questions

1. Because she started university and wanted a place of her own.
2. A safe neighborhood, a reasonable price, and easy access to buses and grocery stores.
3. Because it offered the best balance between comfort, location, and price.

Idioms/Useful Expressions

“Right away” = immediately

The caller says: “I’m kind of desperate, and I need something right away.”

“A little steep” = more expensive than expected

The caller says: “That is a little steep for me.”

“First-come, first-served” = available to whoever arrives first

Norman says: “We rent the apartment on a first-come, first-served basis.”

“Trade-offs” = advantages and disadvantages that must be accepted

Norman says: “Well, there are always trade-offs.”